

CITY OF SOUTH MILWAUKEE PLAN COMMISSION
MEETING MINUTES
Tuesday March 24, 2026

1. Call meeting to order/roll call.

The meeting was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Ald. Brett Briesemeister, Acting Chair. Members present: Chris Haslam, Renee Lindner, Ald. David Bartoshevich, and George Becker. Absent and excused were Mayor Jim Shelenske and Nick Gates.

Also present: Interim City Administrator Jay Shambeau, City Engineer Genevieve Stollenwerk, and Economic Development Manager Ericka Lang.

2. Approval of the January 27, 2026 meeting minutes.

Bartoshevich motioned to approve the minutes, seconded by Haslam. All in favor.

3. Discussion of municipal zoning code amendments for regulations pertaining to:

a. Lot and building regulations for height and setbacks

Lang presented the commission with visual handouts explaining that current height rules rely on several calculations and layers of contextual language, making them hard for contractors and residents to interpret when determining the allowable height of new accessory buildings. If these standards are streamlined it would reduce the amount of staff time spent explaining the code prior to submittal and during project review. One example is where a property owner wanted to build storage over his garage and the garage height would then be higher than the primary structure on the parcel. Haslam stated he would not support a proposal or change allowing a garage to exceed the height of the primary residence while Lindner stated she would be in agreement of the allowance. Commissioners discussed several different scenarios and projects and agree with Lang's recommendation.

b. Driveways and parking slabs

Driveway language is located in the zoning chapter and in chapter 23 Public Peace and Safety. Most of section 23.15 should be relocated to the zoning chapter. It also contradicts some of the zoning code. Since 2008 sect 23.15 only permits driveways and no other improved parking areas except by administrative review. It also limits front or rear yards for parking and driveways to 40%. Commissioners agreed improved parking spaces should not be in the front yard and limited to a single space.

c. Signage

Lang opened up for discussion several updates regarding signage. Revising wall signs language for multi-tenant buildings/strip malls, standards for non-business signage for multiple building complexes and varying uses, limitations for freestanding sign heights, and flagpole heights.

Commissioners agreed height limits on flag poles and some noted the existing freestanding sign height limits are appropriate. Lang will provide code amendment suggestions.

d. Stormwater Management

Stollenwerk explained that the current zoning code includes pre-construction and post-construction stormwater management requirements. Floodplain regulations and

the stormwater utility are established under separate chapters. Illicit discharge provisions were previously included in the zoning code but are no longer part of the current code. Staff is proposing to reorganize stormwater-related regulations by creating a standalone Stormwater Management Chapter. This would include relocating existing erosion control and post-construction standards from the zoning code and reestablishing illicit discharge provisions within the new chapter.

Briesemeister and Haslam raised a few clarifying questions regarding the proposed code reorganization and indicated support for moving forward with the changes. All members were in favor of the reorganization.

4. Update on Scott Crawford Bucyrus Campus development projects at 1100 Milwaukee Ave.

Lang noted that the Planned Development District ordinance requires the plan commission to approve final project plans for landscaping, lighting, parking, building design, signage and site amenities. Building designs were previously fully completed and approved. The site plan, landscaping and lighting plans were not fully completed and signage has not been submitted to date.

Stollenwerk mentioned new site plans were submitted showing updated traffic circulation pertaining to the elementary school in response to the Traffic Impact Analysis. There is concern about the high amount of vehicle traffic from the school that is using the northern entrance on the adjacent manufacturing property that has a shared access easement.

5. Schedule next meeting (April 28, 2026 at 6:30 pm)

6. Adjourn.

Haslam motioned to adjourn the meeting at 7:37 p.m., seconded by Becker. All in favor.

Recorded by

Heidi Eichner
Recording Secretary